Supplement S1 Ethic votum

The study received favourable ethics opinions from the University of Cambridge (Ref. 736, 15 May 2025) and Offenburg University of Applied Sciences (Ref. 04-25, 27 June 2025). Data collection was conducted in compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

A privacy notice and participant information sheet preceded the questionnaire; participation was conditional on informed consent.

Supplement S2 Response distribution of all 19 digital tools

Table S2a. Number of respondents (row %) per response category, all 19 digital tools, sorted by the share answering "unclear what this is". The item analysed in the manuscript is set in bold. Collapsed categories reported in the manuscript: daily or weekly; monthly or less often; "would like to, but not available"; "unclear what this is".

Digital tool	n	Daily	Weekly	Monthly	Less often	Would like to, but not available	Unclear what this is
Differential diagnosis / CDSS	**361**	**21 (5.8)**	**22 (6.1)**	**11 (3.0)**	**78 (21.6)**	**80 (22.2)**	**149 (41.3)**
Patient-facing triage tools (ada, docyet)*	353	3 (0.8)	4 (1.1)	3 (0.8)	117 (33.1)	83 (23.5)	143 (40.5)
Digital pre-registration, emergency care*	350	35 (10.0)	12 (3.4)	14 (4.0)	117 (33.4)	88 (25.1)	84 (24.0)
Medication safety alerts (AMTS)	357	93 (26.1)	38 (10.6)	14 (3.9)	78 (21.8)	68 (19.0)	66 (18.5)
Automated duty rostering	354	20 (5.6)	8 (2.3)	11 (3.1)	137 (38.7)	122 (34.5)	56 (15.8)
Prescribable digital health apps (DiGA)	361	23 (6.4)	37 (10.2)	42 (11.6)	144 (39.9)	59 (16.3)	56 (15.5)
Tele/home monitoring	356	14 (3.9)	20 (5.6)	11 (3.1)	143 (40.2)	128 (36.0)	40 (11.2)
Tele-rounds (ICU, stroke unit, care home)	354	4 (1.1)	13 (3.7)	7 (2.0)	162 (45.8)	129 (36.4)	39 (11.0)
Laboratory information system	360	223 (61.9)	33 (9.2)	7 (1.9)	37 (10.3)	21 (5.8)	39 (10.8)
Image viewing (PACS)	360	156 (43.3)	43 (11.9)	18 (5.0)	71 (19.7)	42 (11.7)	30 (8.3)
Health apps in patient care	360	32 (8.9)	30 (8.3)	23 (6.4)	178 (49.4)	69 (19.2)	28 (7.8)
Telephone assistants (scheduling)	358	52 (14.5)	4 (1.1)	5 (1.4)	132 (36.9)	142 (39.7)	23 (6.4)
Electronic medication list/plan	360	124 (34.4)	46 (12.8)	16 (4.4)	75 (20.8)	81 (22.5)	18 (5.0)
Knowledge resources (Amboss, Thieme)	359	103 (28.7)	119 (33.1)	44 (12.3)	54 (15.0)	22 (6.1)	17 (4.7)
Speech recognition for documentation	360	77 (21.4)	29 (8.1)	8 (2.2)	100 (27.8)	134 (37.2)	12 (3.3)
Practice/hospital information system	363	312 (86.0)	12 (3.3)	5 (1.4)	15 (4.1)	8 (2.2)	11 (3.0)
Video consultation	357	16 (4.5)	27 (7.6)	18 (5.0)	148 (41.5)	138 (38.7)	10 (2.8)
Electronic sick note (eAU)	357	151 (42.3)	43 (12.0)	9 (2.5)	86 (24.1)	62 (17.4)	6 (1.7)
Electronic patient record (ePA)	361	137 (38.0)	27 (7.5)	9 (2.5)	62 (17.2)	124 (34.3)	2 (0.6)

* *[Meaning of the asterisk as in the Figure 1 legend – to be completed by the authors.]*

Table S2b. Logistic regression of "unclear what this is" on age (one unit = one decade; six bands, 20–29 years coded 0), unadjusted and adjusted for healthcare setting (hospital, practice, other) and specialty (general practice, internal medicine, other), for each of the 19 tools. Odds ratios with 95% confidence intervals; p value for the age term in the adjusted model. No estimate where fewer than five respondents answered "unclear".

Digital tool	n	n unclear	OR per decade, unadjusted (95% CI)	OR per decade, adjusted (95% CI)	p (adjusted)
Practice/hospital information system	363	11	0.51 (0.29–0.89)	0.58 (0.31–1.08)	0.084
Electronic patient record (ePA)	361	2	–	–	–
Electronic medication list/plan	360	18	0.98 (0.70–1.39)	1.06 (0.72–1.56)	0.773
Electronic sick note (eAU)	357	6	0.69 (0.36–1.31)	0.88 (0.45–1.72)	0.708
Image viewing (PACS)	360	30	1.38 (1.04–1.81)	1.16 (0.84–1.61)	0.358
Laboratory information system	360	39	0.90 (0.70–1.14)	0.90 (0.68–1.19)	0.458
Differential diagnosis / CDSS	**361**	**149**	**0.76 (0.65–0.89)**	**0.72 (0.60–0.87)**	**<0.001**
Prescribable digital health apps (DiGA)	361	56	0.66 (0.53–0.83)	0.77 (0.59–1.00)	0.049
Health apps in patient care	360	28	0.78 (0.58–1.04)	0.79 (0.55–1.12)	0.188
Telephone assistants (scheduling)	358	23	0.84 (0.61–1.15)	0.90 (0.62–1.30)	0.572
Video consultation	357	10	0.84 (0.53–1.34)	0.90 (0.52–1.56)	0.702
Tele-rounds (ICU, stroke unit, care home)	354	39	1.03 (0.81–1.31)	0.93 (0.70–1.23)	0.603
Tele/home monitoring	356	40	1.13 (0.89–1.43)	1.09 (0.83–1.43)	0.540
Speech recognition for documentation	360	12	1.45 (0.94–2.23)	1.19 (0.71–1.98)	0.509

Digital tool	n	n unclear	OR per decade, unadjusted (95% CI)	OR per decade, adjusted (95% CI)	p (adjusted)
Digital pre-registration, emergency care	350	84	1.15 (0.96–1.37)	0.98 (0.79–1.21)	0.823
Patient-facing triage tools (ada, docyet)	353	143	0.91 (0.78–1.07)	0.86 (0.71–1.03)	0.095
Medication safety alerts (AMTS)	357	66	0.91 (0.75–1.11)	0.78 (0.62–0.99)	0.041
Automated duty rostering	354	56	1.04 (0.85–1.28)	0.98 (0.77–1.25)	0.901
Knowledge resources (Amboss, Thieme)	359	17	1.90 (1.27–2.85)	1.56 (0.96–2.52)	0.069

Supplement S3. AI use for diagnostic tasks and the CDSS item

Table S3. Response to “Differentialdiagnostik bzw. Clinical-Decision-Support (CDSS)” by self-reported use of AI for diagnostic tasks (“Diagnostik und Befund (z.B. Bildanalyse, Mustererkennung, EKG-Auswertung etc.)” selected in the multiple-response item on areas of AI use), overall and by age group; n = 361 respondents with a valid CDSS response. Number of respondents (row %).

Subgroup	AI use for diagnostics	n	Daily or weekly	Monthly or less often	Would like to, but not available	Unclear what this is
All respondents	yes	81	20 (24.7)	20 (24.7)	14 (17.3)	27 (33.3)
All respondents	no	280	23 (8.2)	69 (24.6)	66 (23.6)	122 (43.6)
Age <40	yes	29	5 (17.2)	6 (20.7)	3 (10.3)	15 (51.7)
Age <40	no	103	10 (9.7)	23 (22.3)	18 (17.5)	52 (50.5)
Age 40-59	yes	33	8 (24.2)	9 (27.3)	5 (15.2)	11 (33.3)
Age 40-59	no	112	5 (4.5)	29 (25.9)	30 (26.8)	48 (42.9)
Age ≥ 60	yes	19	7 (36.8)	5 (26.3)	6 (31.6)	1 (5.3)
Age ≥ 60	no	65	8 (12.3)	17 (26.2)	18 (27.7)	22 (33.8)

“Unclear what this is” among AI users 27/81 (33%) versus 122/280 (44%) among non-users: OR 0.65 (95% CI 0.39–1.09), chi-square p = 0.10; adjusted for age (per decade) OR 0.65 (0.38–1.10). Any professional AI use (n = 190): 66/190 (35%) versus 83/171 (49%), OR 0.56 (0.37–0.86), p = 0.008; adjusted for age OR 0.54 (0.35–0.83).